decided that, to start with, we should visit the Pape Avenue Gurudwara and meet members of its management committee. I talked to the president of the local Sikh gurudwara committee on the phone and fixed a meeting with him and other members in the gurudwara office for around noon. He welcomed the idea on the phone, but to our surprise, when we reached the gurudwara there was no trace of the management committee or the president. The two sewadars who met us pretended to have no clue about their whereabouts. From their behaviour it appeared that we were not welcome and they wanted us to leave as soon as possible, lest our presence on the premises should be noticed. In view of that, after paying obeisance to the Guru Granth Sahib we returned to the consulate, disappointed.

Similarly, when the president of the Montreal gurudwara committee came to the high commission at Ottawa for some consular service, I inquired about the welfare of the Sikh community there and asked him if I should visit Montreal on any of the Sundays when they had their functions in the gurudwara. Though outwardly enthusiastic, he never followed it up with an invitation.

The two pro-Khalistan men

During the course of my interaction with Sikhs of diverse backgrounds, I discovered that there were only two persons in Canada who either professed or propagated pro-Khalistan views. One of them was Toronto-based Kuldip Singh Sodhi, self-styled consul general of Khalistan, who represented Jagjit Singh Chauhan's outfit. The other was Professor Uday Singh of Sudbury.

Jagjit Singh Chauhan, a medical doctor by profession, was first elected to the Punjab assembly in 1967 and became its deputy speaker when the Akali Dal-led coalition government took office in Punjab. Later he served as finance minister in Lachman Singh Gill's cabinet. In 1971 he shifted to the United Kingdom. The same year he went to Guru Nanak's birth place, Nankana Sahib in Pakistan, in an attempt to establish a Sikh government in exile. He then visited the US at the invitation of some Republican party members. On 13